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ISCEST NEWS

Issue 1

March 2024

ISCEST Founding President, Professor Steve Azaiki OON, Signs MOU!

The Institute of Science & Technology (IST) Yenagoa, the Azaiki Public Library and The Bayelsa Medical University (BMU) signed a Memorandum of Understanding to work together in bringing educational opportunities to Nigerians, especially those in the University. Arrangements have been finalised in the areas of staff exchange programmes, collaboration in International exchange programmes and support for ISCEST's 10th Anniversary Conference, which is scheduled for 1st –3rd December 2024. Vice Chancellor Professor Nick Etebu did not lose sight of the crucial role that the Azaiki Public Library plays in promoting and sustaining educational advancement for learners. He offered warm commendations to Professor Steve Azaiki OON for setting up the Azaiki Public Library.



Professor Nicholas Etebu, Vice Chancellor Bayelsa Medical University BMU and Professor Steve Azaiki OON at the signing of the MOU

Publish Your Research Paper in CSCEST!



Current Studies in Comparative Education, Science and Technology (CSCEST) is ISCEST's Official Journal. The journal promotes interdisciplinary studies in education, science and technology. It publishes original research and papers that discuss, analyse or evaluate policies, or those that disclose relevant gaps in existing research. For more information on paper submission please visit <http://www.journal.iscest.org/>.

Well Done, Dr Elizabeth Eta!



Dr Elizabeth Eta

Congratulations to ISCEST member, Dr. Elizabeth Eta, on the publication of her new article titled "Constructed World Culture Instruments for European Higher Education Area Global Diffusion" in *Compare: A Journal of Comparative and International Education*. This collaborative work, authored by Dr. Eta from the University of Helsinki, Finland, and Dr. Iryna Kushnir from the University of Kent, United Kingdom, examines policy actors' roles in the dissemination of global education policies.

Every person has two educations, one which he receives from others, and one, more important, which he gives to himself – Edward Gibbon.

Abstract

'Global educational reforms and policy trends suggest a growing convergence in educational systems worldwide, often attributed to the culturally embedded nature of nation-states and world-society models. However, in this article, we argue that these explanations are insufficient to fully account for the global diffusion of certain policies, as they often overlook the influential role of powerful actors in global policy dissemination. We analyse the European Bologna Process (BP) as a global case, highlighting instruments devised by the EHEA actors to actively promote BP reforms and philosophies worldwide. Drawing on World Culture Theory and analysing 25 BP documents, we argue that education policy diffusion occurs because of a well-coordinated structure and established instruments by policy actors for global policy dissemination'.

Keywords: global education policy, world culture theory, Bologna Process, policy diffusion, policy instruments

Read the full article here:

<https://www.tandfonline.com/eprint/X7QQYTVJQFV8XNDSH4QJ/full?target=10.1080/03057925.2024.2314020>

Read All About It!



BAYELSA MEDICAL UNIVERSITY

Imgbí Road,
P.M.B. 178 Yenagoa,
Bayelsa State, Nigeria.

**OFFICE OF THE VICE CHANCELLOR
PUBLIC RELATIONS DEPARTMENT
PRESS RELEASE**

BMU REPOSITIONED FOR EXCELLENCE: GETS ACCREDITATION FOR MEDICINE AND SURGERY, ADMISSION QUOTA INCREASE TO 100 AND TO BE LISTED IN WORLD DIRECTORY OF MEDICAL SCHOOLS- THURSDAY 4TH APRIL, 2024.

The Medical and Dental Council of Nigeria(MDCN) yesterday granted the university accreditation for the Part I Professional Examinations in Medicine and Surgery (MBBS Part I). The Council also increased the admission quota for first year students from 50 to 100 annually. With this feat the University also is automatically listed in the World Directory of Medical Schools.

The Deputy-Registrar of the Council and leader of the delegation, Dr. N. U. Nwakanma, communicated the approval to Management of the University after a rigorous 2-day accreditation exercise in the institution.



HE. SEN. DOUYE DIRI, MDCN TEAM AND BMU MANAGEMENT & PROF. EN. ETEBU, VC BMU

Professor Ebitimitula Etebu, Vice Chancellor of the Bayelsa Medical University expressed joy at the above achievement noting that securing accreditation for Medicine and Surgery programme from the MDCN is a rigorous process that involves meeting stringent standards in terms of the Curriculum, human resources, and clinical facilities. It requires a comprehensive evaluation of the institutions' capabilities to ensure that it can provide quality medical education and training to future doctors.

(Cont'd on p.4)

Read All About It (Cont'd from p.3)



MDCN TEAM AND BMU MANAGEMENT DURING THE ACCREDITATION EXERCISE

The VC noted that for Senate, Management, lecturers, staff and students of BMU, this accreditation signifies the validation of their efforts and demonstrates that the University successfully met the criteria set forth by the MDCN, reflecting the dedication of its management, faculty and staff to uphold the highest standards of medical training. This achievement is not only a source of pride for the University but also a testament to addressing the healthcare needs of the region and beyond. With the accreditation of Medicine and Surgery programme, the University is now poised to produce well trained doctors who can serve their communities with competence, passion, and professionalism. Moreover, accreditation opens up opportunities for collaboration with other institutions both nationally and internationally, enhancing the University's reputation and facilitating partnerships in research, clinical practice and academic exchange.

He described as commendable the ownership and funding of two medical schools by the Bayelsa government and urged the government to among other requests revive the BMU teaching hospital project, provide buses for the institution, continue to employ qualified manpower, build more laboratories as well as complete the satellite campus at Sampou.

According to the Vice Chancellor, for a specialized University striving to build a sure foundation for its students and staff, BMU in line with best practices has gone through the various stages of resource verification and accreditation by National Regulatory bodies. Such visits have been regular for the past months. He stated that the last visit by the MDCN took place on the 26th of January 2023 when the body gave a check list and made recommendations which the University tried its best to implement with the support of the State Government. He explained that for specialized Medical Universities such as BMU the accreditation process usually takes several stages. The accreditation given on Thursday April 4th was the first stage, with subsequent stages to follow.

In his remark, Dr. Nwakanma, Deputy Registrar of the MDCN and leader of the visiting team stated that this first stage accreditation given to BMU to run Medicine and Surgery also implies that its pre-clinical students can now sit for the Part I MBBS examinations coming up soon, adding that the MDCN accreditation ensures that the community and society will be safe in the hands of whoever must have passed through the programme. **(Cont'd on p.5)**

Read All About It (Cont'd from p.4)



WORKING SESSION OF MDCN TEAM AT BMU COUNCIL CHAMBERS

The Vice Chancellor led the MDCN team to pay a courtesy call on the Governor of Bayelsa State and Visitor to the Bayelsa Medical University and to officially present to him the report from the MDCN. He was accompanied by some members of his management team such as Dr. Mrs. Felicia E. Akusu, Registrar; Prof. Uche Onwudiegwu, Provost of the College of Medicine, among others.

The Vice Chancellor Prof. E.N Etebu thanked the Governor of Bayelsa State, His Excellency Sen. Douye Diri for showing commitment and the willingness to place BMU on an excellent footing thus the political will to ensure the needs of the University are met. The VC also thanked Management for supporting him and for the hard work put in. He commended the students of the Bayelsa Medical University for being patient and demonstrating academic excellence. He appealed to His Excellency the Governor to look into the plight of the university in the area of infrastructural development, employment of qualified staff, regularisation of casual staff, utility vehicles, laboratories and the development of the Sampou satellite campus.

Receiving the delegation in Government House, His Excellency expressed satisfaction at the work done by the accreditation panel. He noted that the State Government would support the University in its development efforts and ensure that all students graduate in record time. He also said it was a welcomed development for the first set of Undergraduates of Medicine and Surgery programme currently at the Pre-Clinical stage and preparing for their Part one MBBS Examination. Governor Diri thanked the MDCN for a job well done and congratulated the Vice Chancellor and Management of the University for working tirelessly to achieve this feat.

Dr. Marie Teibowei

Public Relations Officer

(To be continued in the next issue of ISCEST News)

ISCEST Congratulates BMU!

Professor Steve Azaiki OON Extends Heartfelt Condolences



2nd from L— 3rd from left: Professor Azaiki offers condolences to His Excellency Dr Goodluck Jonathan

His Excellency Dr Goodluck Ebele Jonathan GCFR, President of the Federal Republic of Nigeria from 2010 to 2015, mourns the loss of his elder sister Madam Obekhatein Jonathan. She passed away on Thursday 11th January 2024 at the Federal Medical Centre in Yenagoa, Bayelsa State. Madam Jonathan, also known as Amissi was a retired teacher and business woman. She is survived by her mother, Mama Eunice Afeni-Jonathan, her three children and siblings. The funeral service was held in Otuke on 16th February 2024.

The entire ISCEST Family extends sincerest sympathies to His Excellency Dr Goodluck Ebele Jonathan GCFR on the passing of his beloved sister Madam Obekhatein Jonathan.



Congratulations to Dr Tonye Sampson!

Dr. Tonye Sampson achieves another milestone achievement. Dr Sampson was promoted to the rank of Reader (Associate Professor) in Environmental and Public Health Microbiology in the prestigious Rivers State University, Nigeria.



Dr Tonye Sampson

Success is no accident. It is hard work, perseverance, learning, studying, sacrifice and most of all, love of what you are doing or learning to do -
Pele, Brazilian Soccer Player.

More Collaboration Opportunities for IST and ISCEST!

Anthony Onyemaechi Elumelu CFR , also known as Tony Elumelu; Chairman Heirs Holdings, Transcorp, United Bank for Africa and Founder of Tony Elumelu Foundation with Professor Steve Azaiki OON, Founding President International Society of Comparative Education, Science & Technology Nigeria (ISCEST) and Chairman Governing Council Institute of Science & Technology Yenagoa, discuss collaboration opportunities for ISCEST and Institute of Science Technology. The meeting was held in Lagos.



L-R: Professor Steve Azaiki & Tony Elumelu

A Sympathy Message From Professor Steve Azaiki

26th January, 2024



Professor David Turner,
Member Advisory Board,
International Society of Comparative Education, Science & Technology,
Nigeria.

Dear Professor Turner,

Condolence Message on the Passing on to higher glory of your dear wife, Lupita.

I write on behalf of my family, Political associates and colleagues to express our deepest sympathy over the death of your dear wife, Dr Lupita Turner, who was the Secretary General for the World Education Fellowship (WEF).

The International Society for Comparative Education, Science & Technology, ISCEST Nigeria, its members, staff and colleagues miss an erudite scholar who dedicated her entire life to promoting life long learning and spreading knowledge even in Africa.

We in Nigeria will forever remember her participation and contribution to the establishment of ISCEST Nigeria. I recollect her participation and contributions at the first Conference of ISCEST in far flung Yenagoa in BAYELSA State of Nigeria. Dr Lupita Turner employed her knowledge as an educational consultant at Education for all to help us streamline our curriculum at the Institute of Science & Technology Yenagoa and painstakingly worked on establishing the now established ISCEST journal, (name the journal).

The University/ academic community will miss a woman who was dedicated in sharing knowledge. ISCEST and Africa will miss an academic who never allowed distance and color to be a barrier in given knowledge. Dr Lupita Turner was a good friend of Nigeria. We mourn with you my dear Professor David Turner. I pray God to give you the fortitude to bear this painful and irreplaceable loss of your beautiful and loving wife. May her gentle soul rest in peace.

Sincerely, Professor Steve Azaiki
Founding President ISCEST
Chairman, Nigeria National Think Tank

In Memoriam: Mrs Lupita Turner, General Secretary, WEF International

On behalf of the World Education Fellowship:

It is with deep sorrow and heavy hearts that I announce the passing of Mrs Lupita Turner, the dedicated Secretary General of the World Education Fellowship (WEF). Mrs Turner died peacefully on 7th January 2024, surrounded by family and loved ones.

Lupita was a pillar of strength and commitment within the WEF International, tirelessly contributing to the success and functioning of the WEF. Her unwavering dedication to the work and activities of the WEF has left an indelible mark, and her absence will be profoundly felt by colleagues, members, and me personally, who I knew and worked with so very closely.

In honour of the departed Secretary General, a special issue of *the New Era in Education*, the official Journal of the WEF, will be published in late February/March and I would like to invite colleagues and friends to share their cherished memories and anecdotes of their experiences with Mrs Turner. Please send your contributions, along with any photos you would like to share, to me directly by 7 February. I believe that coming together to reminisce about Mrs Turner's impact will provide comfort and solace during this difficult time.

May her soul rest in peace.

Professor James Ogunleye
Editor, *New Era in Education*
For the WEF International

ISCEST Extends Condolences to Professor David Turner

The entire ISCEST Family extends sincerest condolences to Professor David Turner on the passing of his wife Lupita Turner. Professor Turner and his wife have been valuable members of ISCEST since its inauguration in December 2014..



“We Mourn a Good Friend of ISCEST, Mr Ibu”

Died: John Ikechukwu Okafor popularly known as Mr Ibu was a friend of mine whose purpose on earth was to make us happy and laugh. Meeting him or having an evening with him is a journey in to laughter. He was also caring and showed concern to those who are suffering. He liked to help people. He was loyal to friendship and indeed expected same from friends and colleagues. John appeared in over 200 Nollywood films including those from Mr Ibu series. His death is a great loss to Nollywood and Nigeria. Indeed Africa will miss some good laughter in their homes. My condolences to his family. God take him in to your bosom.



Above L-R: John Okafor & Professor Steve Azaiki
Below: John Okafor



XVIII World Congress of Comparative Education Societies

Theme: *Fostering Inclusive Ecologies of Knowledge: Education for Equitable and Sustainable Futures*

22-26 July 2024, Cornell University, Ithaca, New York, USA



From Page 11.

Attend International Education Conferences!



Bulgarian Comparative Education Society

XXII BCES Annual International Conference

Sandanski, Bulgaria 2 - 5 July 2024

03 September 2024 - 05
September 2024

The University of Sussex
Falmer, Brighton , BN1 9RH



KIE Annual International Conference & Networking Events

Knowledge, Innovation & Enterprise Conference

Theme: ***When in Rome: Local Inspiration for Global Innovation***

23-25 July 2024, Rome, ITALY.

Global Issues in Education and Research

THE 10TH INTERNATIONAL CONFERENCE
ON **EDUCATION 2024**

Colombo, Sri Lanka

02nd, 03rd & 04th May 2024



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An Invitation from the ISCEST President!

Academics, researchers, teachers, students, consultants, policy makers, curriculum developers, other interested professionals and friends and supporters of the International Society of Comparative Education Science and Technology (ISCEST) are invited to attend the 11th annual international ISCEST conference which takes place from 01—03 December 2024.



Professor Nedie Akani

This is a very special conference because it is ISCEST's 10th Anniversary. All are invited to get involved by presenting a paper and/or by participating in the plenary sessions.

THEME: *Nationalising International Comparative Education Spaces: Propositions, Prospects and Praxes*

VENUE: Azaiki Public Library, W7MM+32H, Imgbi Street, Yenagoa 569101, Bayelsa State, Nigeria.

See <http://www.iscest.org> for the Call for Papers.

***Come One and All!
Celebrate with ISCEST!***

We Thank You!

*We openly acknowledge
That many thanks are due
So here's an expression
To say that we appreciate you!*

Gertrude Shotte

